Chapter 20

O paranda – The floor

Enoch Horai Magum



(a) (b)

Figure 1: (a) *Kobuu* – Kobuu palm (*Cyrtostachys Ioriae*),
(b) *Paranda* – Floor

(1)	*O paranda o peho taba vaa tea inu teara a ta Teapu.*	The floor is a thing in our house, of us, the Teop people.
(2)	*Eove to kom, hio ae goroho raara.*	It is where we step, sit, and sleep on.

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(3)	*O paranda na vavaobete raara toon na naono vai to dao raara bono hogo.*	We put the floor onto the beams that we call *hogo* (floor joists).
(4)	*O paranda na pakupaku raara bono kobuu.*	We make the floor from the *kobuu* palm (*Cyrtostachys species*).
(5)	*Tea meha maa vaan na pakupaku riori bono kumako.*	In other villages they make it from the kugumaru palm (*Areca novohibernica*).
(6)	*Beara tau paku o paranda, eara toro ipinoo roho a bebeahu ae a tatabonata na inu bono kara urisi.*	When we are about to make the floor, we must measure the length and the width of the house with a tape made of the wild banana sheath.[1]
(7)	*O kara urisi bona to kahi dee raara rasuu to kahi ipinoo raara o kobuu.*	This wild banana sheath tape we take to the jungle where we will measure the *kobuu* palm.
(8)	*Beara suguna teo hum to tei nae o kobuu, eara paa sisira roho tea tabae o kobuu toro paku ara bono paranda toro vuaba vai o manoto.*	When we have arrived at the place where the *kobuu* palm stands, we carefully examine it, because the *kobuu* palm from which we will make the floor must be a mature one.
(9)	*Beara viana vakavara o kobuu vai tau paku ara o paranda, eara repaa mosi gunaha e.*	When we have chosen the *kobuu* palm that we are about to make the floor from, we cut it down.
(10)	*O kobuu vai o kobusu saka mataa haana,*	The young and moist *kobuu* palm is not good,
(11)	*eikou na antee vaha koana tea koava, evehee o vuaba vai o manoto vamataa na antee nana tea tei vananaoana.*	because it can easily rot, but the fully mature palm can last for a long time.
(12)	*Beo kobuu obete nana putaa, eara repaa ipinoo e,*	When the *kobuu* palm is lying on the ground, we measure it,
(13)	*eara repaa rom suku bata koara o ipinoo.*	and then we just cut the stem crosswise according to the measure.
(14)	*Beara romrom vakavara e, eara repaa paku pete a kiu vaa tea kopaa.*	When we have finished cutting it up crosswise, we subsequently do the work of cutting it lengthwise.

(15) *Eara he toro kopaa e teo hum buaku.* But we must cut it lengthwise into two pieces.

(16) *Tea kiu vaa tea kopaa, eara toro kiu nia buaku a toraaraa, ae amaa ta ginuva.* For the work of the lengthwise cutting, we must work with two axes and some wedges.

(17) *Tea kopaa, eara toro mosi momohu nia peha toraaraa,* For the lengthwise cut, we must first make a cut with one axe,

(18) *ore topo vakisi nana, beara mosi nia vaabuaku.* so that it is still stuck (in the stem) when we make a cut with the second (axe).

(19) *A vaabuaku re topo vakisi nana, beara rahi pute a toraaraa momohu,* Then the second (axe) is still stuck (in the stem), when we pull out the first axe,

(20) *beara tapa bata ni naora amaa ta ginuva teo hum to mosi vaakaa bata naona a bua toraaraa.* while we are driving the wedges into the stem where the two axes cut it lengthwise open.

(21) *Eara pasi paku bata koa vo naora teebona, ore antee komana beo rom kobuu takopaa.* We will do it like this until the stem of the *kobuu* palm is cut open lengthwise.

(22) *Be kavara o hum kiu bona, eara repaa paku pete o hum vaa tea kopaa varutarutaa e.* When this part of work is finished, we continue with the part of cutting it bit by bit lengthwise (into two halves).

(23) *A kiu bona sa beera vaha haana,* This work is not big again,

(24) *na antee koana bona peha toraaraa.* it only needs one axe.

(25) *Beara kopaa varutarutaa bata rae, eara mee toro ipinoo batara a tatabonata bona bebeahu na kobisi kuriraara.* While we are cutting it open lengthwise bit by bit, we must also measure the width with the length of our finger.

(26) *Be kavara a kiu bona, eara repaa tarataraha kahie bono ogana nae* When this work is finished, we carve its soft inside out

(27) *ae taraha taatagi koa amaa ta kobuu, ore paa kavara kou a kiu vaa teebona.* and just carefully carve off some pieces of *kobuu* palm, and then indeed the work on it is finished.

(28) *A kiu vaa tea paku paranda a hihivaa,* The work of making the floor is difficult,

(29) *eikou o kobuu o taba kikis, ei me vaaponis rakaha nana bona kiu bona.*

because the *kobuu* palm is a hard thing, and this also makes this work very heavy.

(30) *Ei, eara deedee voosu vai, are paa no vaobete e tea inu ore paa tavus paranda.*

Now, we carry it home, then we make it lie in the house, so that it becomes a floor.[2]

[1]See Chapter 11:88ff.

[2]The floor is also made of sago-palm stems, see Chapter 6:28.